

1. Does role identity predict volunteer behavior and intention?
2. Does organizational reputation affect volunteering intention in nonprofits?
3. How well does an identity-based model of blood donation generalize to volunteering behavior?
4. What predicts volunteer retention in nonprofit organizations?
5. Does past volunteering behavior predict future volunteer intention?
6. Is social media engagement associated with volunteering intention toward nonprofits?

Yes, role identity predicts volunteering, reputation supports intention and retention, and there is no direct evidence here on social media engagement.

These six questions split into **identity-based prediction**, **organizational predictors of intention and retention**, and **past behavior plus evidence gaps**.

Identity-Based Prediction

Role identity predicts **volunteer intention** and often later behavior, especially when identity is behavior-specific rather than a general “helpful person” self-view (White et al., 2017; Grube & Piliavin, 2000). In a 3-year study, role identity predicted later volunteer performance through intentions, and it fully mediated links from attitude, social norms, past behavior, and parental modelling to performance (Marta et al., 2014).

- **Behavior-specific identity** predicted intention across money, time, and blood giving (White et al., 2017).
- Identity-based models from **blood donation generalize partly** to volunteering, because the same role-identity logic applied across blood, time, and money outcomes (White et al., 2017).
- Generalization is **context-limited**: in COVID mutual aid, prior volunteer role identity predicted later helping only indirectly through beneficiary closeness and community identification (Wakefield et al., 2021).

Organizational Predictors

Organizational reputation affects willingness to volunteer, and organizational experience shapes retention-related outcomes (Schloderer et al., 2014; Groza & Groza, 2021). Retention is also predicted by identity, commitment-like attachment, pride, and supportive role conditions rather than by identity alone (Grube & Piliavin, 2000; Bang et al., 2022).

Predictor	Outcome	Best-supported finding
NPO reputation	Volunteering intention	Reputation affects willingness to work as a voluntary member, with stronger relevance in some demographic subgroups (Schloderer et al., 2014)
Reputation and community relations	Return intention	They increase pride, and pride increases likelihood of returning and future hours (Groza & Groza, 2021)
Specific volunteer identity	Retention	It predicts intent to remain and hours worked (Grube & Piliavin, 2000)

Predictor	Outcome	Best-supported finding
POS and role clarity	Volunteer attitudes	They raise satisfaction, which improves attitudes toward volunteering (Bang et al., 2022)

FIGURE 1 Organizational and identity predictors of volunteering intention and retention.

Past Behavior and Gaps

Past volunteering behavior predicts future volunteering in the available longitudinal evidence, but usually as one predictor among identity and TPB variables (White et al., 2017; Marta et al., 2014). More broadly, volunteer retention appears to emerge from repeated role enactment, identity validation, meaningfulness, and organizational belonging (Thoits, 2012; Thoits, 2021).

- **Past behavior** predicted later volunteering time at follow-up (White et al., 2017).
- More time in the role appears to **strengthen volunteer identity**, which can sustain repeated service (Thoits, 2012; Van Ingen & Wilson, 2017).
- There is **no direct evidence in these 20 papers** that social media engagement predicts volunteering intention toward nonprofits.

Overall, **role identity is a robust predictor of volunteer intention and persistence, organizational reputation matters for volunteering support and retention, and social media engagement remains unaddressed in the supplied evidence.**

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